

1 Stormy weather

Dark, violent storm clouds build up where warm, moist air rising from the land meets cool, dry air in the sky.

Around 1,000
tornadoes a year
strike in the United
States, mostly in
an area called
**Tornado
Alley.**

Tornadoes spin at speeds of up to 200 mph (320 kph).

4 Blown away

The strong, whirling winds suck up and destroy anything lying in their path. A tornado can tear up trees, buildings, and cars, then drop them many miles away after it has weakened.

Quick quiz



How long can tornadoes last?



What is a waterspout?



How fast do tornadoes spin?